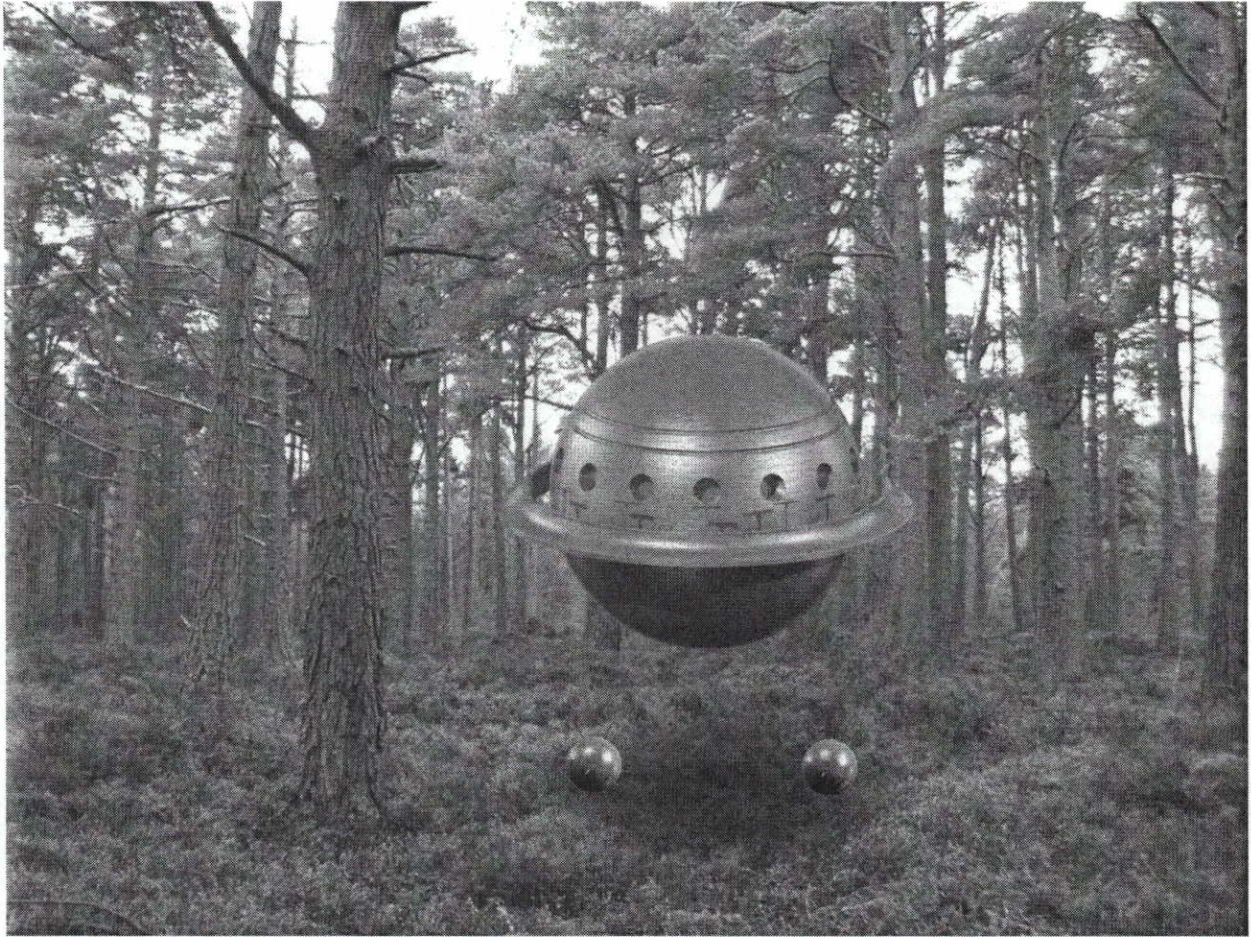




Assault by strange spheres reported in Scotland



On November 9, 1979 Robert Taylor (forester with the Livingston Development Corporation), left his house in the morning around 10:30 AM to inspect a few young trees within the vicinity of Livingston Scotland (United Kingdom). He was riding in an official Forestry Department van, and eventually parked on the side of the road due to the heavy tree growth in the area. Proceeding on foot (with his dog), Mr. Taylor turned a nearby corner and caught sight of an unusual craft. The object appeared to be spherical in shape, with a strange collar running along the outer circumference. The UFO was hovering a few feet above the ground, and made no sound. Its exterior was dark grey metallic in color, and its texture resembled that of sandpaper. On some areas of the craft, it appeared to be transparent. There were also a series of portholes running along the outside. Mr. Taylor estimated its size to be approximately twenty feet in diameter.

Then, Taylor was shocked and amazed to see two smaller sphere shaped objects (measuring three feet in diameter), exit the bottom of the UFO. They quickly approached him, and appeared to have the same exterior texture of the larger craft. However, the smaller objects had "spikes" or appendages sticking out (similar to war-time naval mines). As they rolled across the ground in

his direction, they made a strange "plopping" noise. Upon reaching him, the objects attached themselves (one on each trouser leg below the pockets). Then, Taylor felt that the small spheres were tugging him in the direction of the larger craft. He also noticed a strange smell emanated from the objects that resembled "burnt automobile brake linings". He was now being dragged on the ground towards the craft, and eventually lost consciousness. When he woke up, the objects were gone, and he noticed that he had lost his voice. He also tried to stand, but lost the use of his legs. Eventually, Mr. Taylor crawled the 300 feet back to his van, and tried without success to use his two-way radio to alert the authorities. Attempting to drive back to safety, Mr. Taylor got caught in soft soil and could not drive out. Somewhat recovering after the incident, Taylor was then forced to stagger the mile back to his home. Source: APRO Bulletin July 1980, Journal of Transient Aerial Phenomena Vol. 1, No. 2, March 1980.

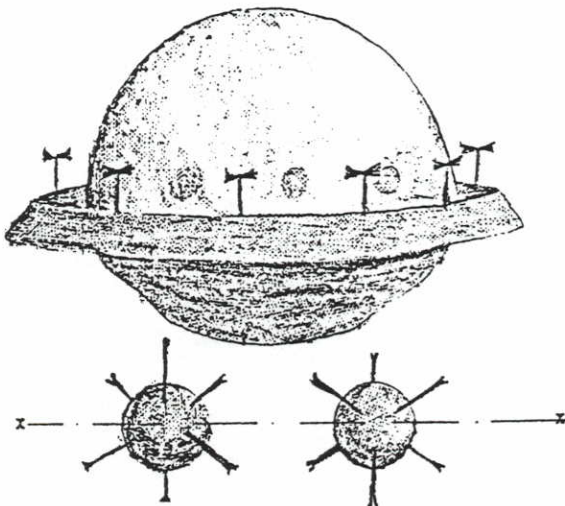
the apro bulletin

VOL. 29, NO. 1

THE A.P.R.O. BULLETIN

JULY, 1980

THE SCOTTISH LANDING CASE



(See Story at Right)

Figure 1: The appearance of the UFO and 'mines', as described by the witness, but drawn by others. X-X indicates the axis of rotation of the 'mines'.

UFOS INSPIRE WELL DRILLING?

Almost every night for the last 7 years, Pat McGuire believes his farm, located 30 miles north of Laramie, has been visited by humanoid beings traveling in multi-colored UFOs. His sightings are confirmed by his wife and eight children, as well as Dan and Ruth Grover who also live on the farm. McGuire describes the UFOs as about 300 feet wide and 60 feet tall and capable of amazing speed.

McGuire's relationship with the UFO beings began in 1971, he believes, with a compulsion to dig a well in the prairie basin that is now his home. He was told by geologists that there wasn't enough water in the basin for an irrigation well, and several drilling companies refused to drill the well for him, saying that it was a waste of time. He started making plans to drill the well on his own and everyone was surprised when he tapped into an underground river at 350 feet. McGuire's well can now pump 8,000 gallons of water per minute and has turned his sagebrush desert into 5,100 acres of irrigated grassland. Drillers who have since tried to tap the underground river in other locations have all failed.

It wasn't until 1978 that McGuire began to under-

(See Drilling, Page 4)

The February 1980 (Vol. 28, #8) issue of the *Bulletin* contained a preliminary report on the alleged encounter of a West Lothian, Scotland forester with a strange object and equally strange smaller objects or "entities". The "happening" took place on November 9, 1979, and the following is the information gleaned from additional clippings and mainly from the *Journal of Transient Aerial Phenomena*, Vol.1, No.2, March, 1980. Strangely enough, the article was written by Stuart Campbell, the architect who initially identified the object(s) as manifestation(s) of ball lightning. However, it does seem that Mr. Campbell is being fairly objective, and the following are the "gleanings". We refer the readers to the February, 1980 (Vol. 28, #8) issue of the *Bulletin* to save space and repetition.

Robert Taylor, forester, (sixteen years tenure with the Livingston Development Corporation) and now a foreman, left his home in Lothian at 1000 GMT in a Forestry Department van, to inspect young trees to the North of the town near highway M8. As he could not drive the van all the way due to the density of trees, he left it on the side of the roadway and proceeded on foot.

Mr. Taylor, accompanied by his dog—walked the rest of the way, and at about 10:15 he rounded a corner in the forest path (100 meters from the road but out of sight of it) and came upon a strange sight.

Before him was a rounded object with a rim-like appendage (according to *Journal of Transient Aerial Phenomena*) not unlike a circular platform (see drawing, reproduced from JTAP, artist not identified).

At first the smaller objects were not in evidence, according to Taylor. The larger object was hovering above the ground, neither moving nor making any sound. The "thing" was dark grey with a texture similar to that of sand-paper. It appeared to become transparent in one area or another, seemingly, to Taylor, to "camouflage" itself. The "craft" was estimated to be twenty feet (six meters) in diameter.

Taylor said he stood, amazed, and stared at the object, then two small objects (apparently coming from under the large object) "rushed" toward him. They had a color and texture similar to that of the "parent" object, but were outfitted with appendages (see figure 1). They rolled on a horizontal axis and made a "plopping" noise as the "legs" made contact with the ground.

Upon reaching him, these objects each attached itself to one (each) of his trouser legs, just below the pockets on the sides. Taylor felt them tug him toward the large object and at the same time, he said, he was nearly suffocated by a strong acrid smell which he

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compared with that of burning automobile brake linings and which he felt came from the "things".

Taylor became aware that he was being dragged forward and his boots were scraping on the ground, before he lost consciousness, and fell forward and laid face downwards.

When Taylor regained consciousness, the objects were gone, but his dog was with him. He tried to speak to her but found he had lost his voice. He tried to stand but his legs would not support him, so he crawled approximately 90 meters (300 ft.) back up the trail toward his van, and then unsteadily half crawled and half staggered the rest of the 430 meters to his van. There, he attempted to contact his headquarters via two-way radio but was unsuccessful because of his voice.

Taylor then attempted to back the van up the track but unfortunately he ran off the track onto soft ground and could not get it out. Using short cuts through woods and fields, he walked the remaining 1600 meters back to his home, arriving at 11:30 a.m. During his walk between his van and his home his voice returned.

Upon seeing her husband's state when he arrived home, Mrs. Taylor assumed he had been attacked and started to call the police, but Taylor stopped her and had her call Mr. Malcolm Drummond, the head of the Forestry Department and his superior. Drummond immediately went to the Taylor residence and he and Taylor went back to the scene of the encounter where they found strange holes in the ground which Taylor said had not been there before that morning. Mrs. Taylor had noticed some unaccountable tears in his trousers in the areas where Taylor claimed the small objects had attached themselves.

Mr. Taylor was later examined by his Doctor who found only a "grase" (scrape?) on his chin and on his thigh. The Doctor sent him to the Bangour hospital for a skull X-ray but Taylor checked himself out before this was accomplished. (Editor's note: This may strike some readers as odd, but if Scottish hospitals are anything like American ones, any tests except for those required in *dire* emergencies, are only undertaken on weekdays and it is *possible* Taylor didn't relish a hospital stay over the weekend for an X-ray, especially if he had no pain in his head, and so far the reports do not indicate that he did).

The following excerpts were taken from the "Journal of Transient Aerial Phenomena" with their permission: "The ground marks (see Figure 3) were of two types. First, there were two isolated ladder type

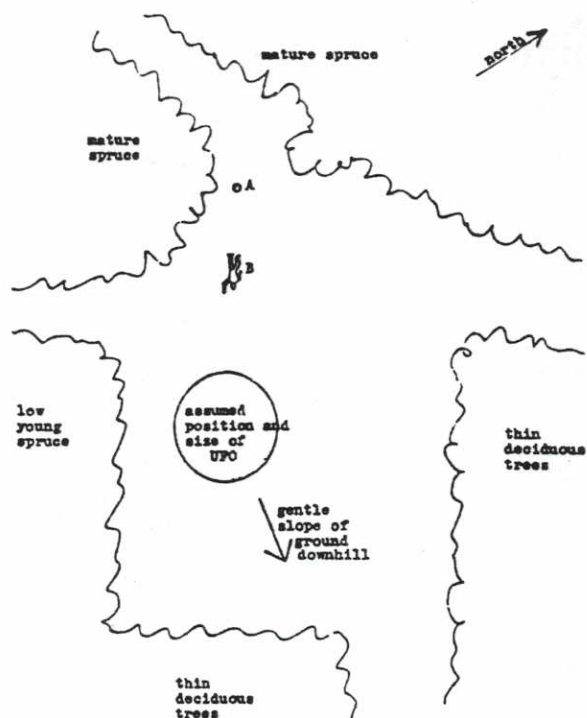


Figure 2: Plan of site and surrounding area

"tracks" about 2.5 m long and the same distance apart. Each "rung" of the ladder (see Photograph 1), was 2 or 3 cm wide and deep, and about 30 cm long, and the area of grass between each "rung" was evenly flattened, but not as deeply as the "rungs". Although the "tracks" appear to be impressions made by a heavy object, the indentations were only in the grass; they did not alter the ground profile under the grass as they would have done if subjected to a heavy weight. The grass blades were each folded and formed to follow the outline of a rectangular indentations."

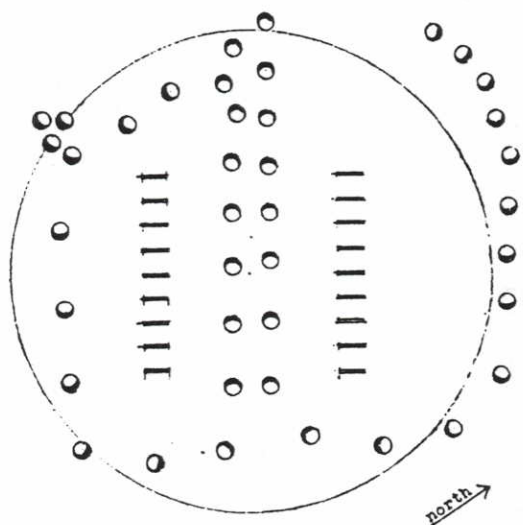
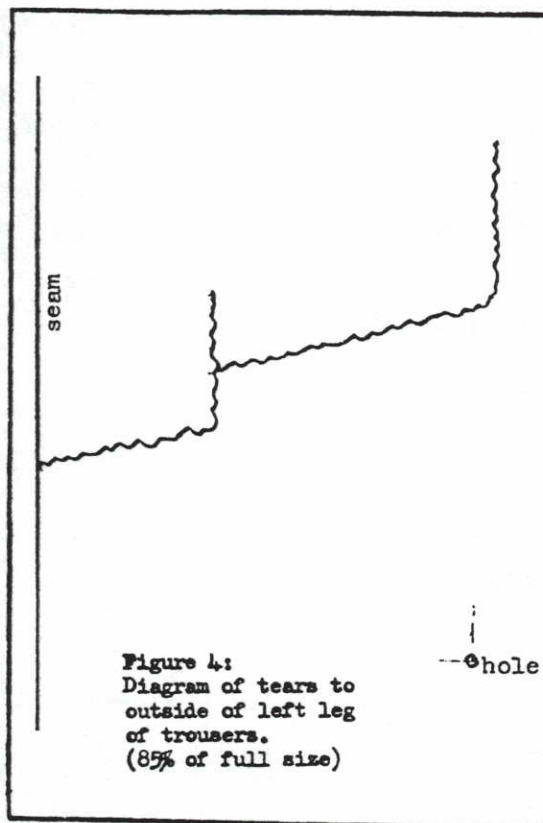


Figure 3: Plan of site markings from Police measurements.
 O shading indicates top side of angled holes.
 6 m diameter circle is assumed position of UFO as shown on Figure 2.

"Secondly there were 40 holes surrounding the "tracks", as shown in Figure 3. These holes all exposed fresh earth and were tapered from a maximum width of about 10cm, but at an angle as shown. The angle was fairly shallow; about 30° to the horizontal. A remarkable feature was the fact that the direction of the angle of the holes was consistent and always in line with the next hole in line. Two distinct and related sets of holes can be detected, and it is clear that one set of holes proceeds clock-wise, while the other proceeds anticlock-wise, and that they are in tandem between the "tracks". In some cases, blades of grass surrounding the edge of a hole were sheared off."

"No grass was scorched. The marks were measured and recorded by the local police the same day, and the area fenced off by the Forestry Department. The marks were photographed by Alastair Sutherland (a friend of a member of the Forestry Department) and by me, the following day."



"Robert Taylor's clothes (including the trousers) were taken by the police for forensic examination. Only the trousers and his long underpants showed anything unusual. Figure 4 and 5 show the tears on each leg of the trousers, which are made of navy blue serge. The right leg tear is about 65cm up from the bottom of the leg, while the left tear is about 76cm up."
